

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 66**Culture (OWC):** [Luo \(FL11\)](#)**Region:** Africa**Sub Region:** Eastern Africa**Field Date:** 1978-1982**Coverage Date:** 1900-1989**Place Coverage:** Siaya, Luoland, Kenya**Section Title(S):** The Gorogoro Economy

The *gorogoro* economy

The short rains had failed at the end of 1983, and so by February 1984 many women had no food in their granaries. It was a particularly bad year for Lewnida. In January, she had successfully delivered her ninth child, but that had left her sickly for a long time. There was no food in her granary and Lewnida had six school-going children to feed every day. She kept writing to her husband, a carpenter in the Mathare Valley, Nairobi, but the beginning of the year is a bad season for the self-employed, so he had no money to send. Lewnida tried out her alternatives: she sent out her children to eat in the neighbouring homesteads. And then she got very sick and had to borrow 50 shillings from church funds for travel to Siaya, and for food. Early in April the husband wrote, enclosing 30 shillings as his contribution. On seeing the contents of the envelope, Lewnida wept.

261
[Gratification And
Control Of Hunger](#)

434
[Income And Demand](#)

731
[Disasters](#)

121
Theoretical
Orientation

369
Urban And Rural Life

434
Income And Demand

113
Bibliographies In
Sources

244
Vegetable Production

369
Urban And Rural Life

134
Soil

318
Human Effects On
Environment

433
Production And
Supply

464
Labor Supply And
Employment

6. This is a joke frequently told from the 1950s up to the present. It suggests the hopelessness in the economic position of the segmented household, combining wage labour in the urban area and small-plot farming in the western Kenya countryside. Cassava is planted as a precaution against financial failure and hunger.

755 Prospect Street
New Haven, CT 06511

Issues and Bugs: hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)